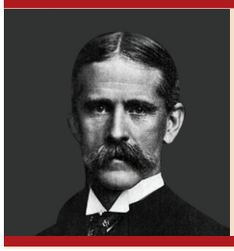
About the Poet



Henry Van Dyke (1852 – 1933) was an American author, poet, educator, and clergyman. He served as a professor of English literature at Princeton University between 1899 and 1923. He was elected to the American Academy of Arts and Letters and received many other honours.

Glossary

mourning (v)	-	feeling or expressing great sadness
veils (v)	-	to hide or cover something so that you cannot see it clearly or understand it
crown (n)	-	a prize or position offered for being the best
quest (n)	-	a long search for something that is difficult to find
unreluctant* (adj.)	-	willing to do something *(*This form is generally not used but the poet has coined it for emphasis)*

Sonnet

The word **sonnet** is derived from the Italian word "sonetto," which means a 'little song' or 'small lyric'. In poetry, a sonnet has 14 lines, and is written in 'iambic pentameter' *(A line with ten syllables, accented on every second beat)*. The first eight lines of a sonnet is known as "octave" and the last six lines is known as "sestet". Sonnets can be categorized on the basis of their rhyme scheme.

A. Read the following lines from the poem and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Let me but live my life from year to year,*
   With forward face and unreluctant soul;

   a. Whom does the word 'me' refer to?
   b. What kind of life does the poet want to lead?

2. *Not hurrying to, nor turning from the goal;*
   Not mourning for the things that disappear

   a. Why do you think the poet is not in a hurry?
   b. What should one not mourn for?

3. *In the dim past, nor holding back in fear*
   From what the future veils; but with a whole
   And happy heart, that pays its toll
   To Youth and Age, and travels on with cheer.

   a. What does the poet mean by the phrase 'in the dim past'?
   b. Is the poet afraid of future? c. How can one travel on with cheer?

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